

Black Americans, Architects of Global Music, Dance, and Culture

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Abstract

Black Americans stand as the creators of every major music genre in the United States of America. An evolution through work songs, spirituals, ragtime, jazz, blues, country, rock and roll, R&B, soul, funk, disco, and hip hop captivated the world. Documentation further shows Black Americans as hidden creators of Reggae and Afrobeat, genres built on a foundation of Black American rhythms, harmonies, and techniques embraced by foreign performers. As cultural and musical geniuses, Black Americans experienced parallel campaigns by the United States, the United Kingdom, Nazi Germany, and regions across the planet. While one faction viewed the sensual sounds as a universal threat, the other asserted dominance over the expressions with claims of ownership. The work presents a chronological record of musicians and compositions.

Introduction

Afrocentrics spoke three words, *call and response*, to bestow Black American music genres upon Africans. History recorded bajars in Mesopotamia, Egypt, and later, West Africa. The enslaved carved string instruments from materials found in the environment. Artists expressed the depths of despair to the euphoria of freedom. Eurocentrics asserted authorship of Black American entertainment through European musical customs and fashion. String, wind, and percussive instruments developed globally, and concepts for the Greek Pythagorean scale originated in Egypt. Elements of suits converged on the Silk Road, with Chinese split-legged garments, Persian, Egyptian, and Steppe nomad coats.

Black American music evolved from bondage, churches, urban life, and a sense of freedom. As award presentations, halls of fame, and academics honored interpreters of Black American music, the stars of the genres sat in the audience.

"The song of an uncaged bird sounds like no other."

Hollywood

Technological geniuses and cinematic icons, Black Americans stood at the forefront of entertainment. The Edison Company developed the Projectoscope, which used carbon filament invented by Lewis Latimer. Berlinger, Columbia, and Thomas Edison recorded Black Americans, c. 1,890 CE. *"Something Good-Negro Kiss"* c. 1,898 CE, portrayed Black American life with tender romantic scenes. Born to a father enslaved by French Huguenots, Oscar Micheaux shined as one of the first Black American filmmakers. The Golden Age of Black Hollywood created superstars—Josephine Baker, Lena Horne, Eartha Kitt, Pearl Bailey, Dorothy Dandridge, Theresa Harris, Katherine Dunham, Joyce Bryant, Nia Mae McKinney, Ruby Dee, Ossie Davis, Paul Robeson, and Diahann Carroll.

Stand-Up Comedy

Stand-up comedy featured minstrel shows, followed by vaudeville, c. 1,800-1,930 CE. Foreigners mocked Black Americans, notably, Stepin Fetchit, a Jamaican. Frederick Douglass called *"blackface"* performers *"The filthy scum of white society"* in The North Star newspaper, c. 1,848 CE. Against a tide of exploitative images—Uncle Ben and Aunt Jemima—the Chitlin' Circuit featured Black American talent, c. 1,930-1,970 CE.

Propaganda depicted lazy, idiotic, submissive, and violent villains. The characters evolved into blaxploitation stereotypes.

The Architects of Music and Dance

Work Songs: The enslaved and imprisoned chain gangs, c. 1,500-1,900 CE, sang work songs. *"It was a 'long, loud, musical shout, rising and falling and breaking into falsetto."* -Frederick Law Olmsted, c. 1,853 CE

Spirituals *"Slave Songbook,"* c. 1,867 CE

Preservationists of Spirituals: Mahalia Jackson, Shirley Caesar, *"The Father Of Modern Gospel Music,"* Andraé Crouch, Gary Davis, *"The Father Of Gospel Music,"* Thomas A. Dorsey, *"Mother of Gospel,"* Sallie Martin, Albertina Walker, The Winans, *"Crown Prince Of Gospel,"* James Cleveland, Sam Cooke, Aretha Franklin, Sister Rosetta Tharpe...

Barber Shop Quartet: Unique Quartette, *"Mamma's Black Baby Boy,"* c. 1,893 CE, and Dinwiddie Colored Quartet, *"Down At The Old Camp Ground,"* c. 1,902 CE.

Ragtime: Scott Joplin, *"King of Ragtime"* Chicago World's Fair performer, c. 1,893 CE. *"Please Say You Will,"* c. 1895 CE and *"The Entertainer"/"The Ice Cream Truck Song,"* c. 1901 CE.. George Washington Johnson, *"The Laughing Song,"* c. 1,896 CE.

Jazz: Charles "Buddy" Bolden *"The First Jazzman,"* c. 1,895 CE, *"Funky Butt"* aka *"Buddy Bolden's Blues."*

Versatile Four, *"Down Home Rag,"* Wilbur Sweatman, c. 1,916 CE. Joseph Nathan Oliver, *"King Oliver"* *"New Orleans Stomp,"* c. 1,923 CE.

Big Band Jazz and Swing: The Duke Ellington Band, *"King Of Swing"* *"Soda Fountain Rag"* aka *"Poodle Dog Rag,"* c. 1,914 CE. Cab Calloway and His Orchestra, Cotton Club performance, c. 1,927 CE. *"Minnie The Moocher,"* c. 1,931 CE. Count Basie's Big Band, c. 1,935 *"One O'Clock Jump,"* c. 1,937 CE. Lionel Hampton Orchestra, c. 1,940 CE. *"Flying Home,"* c. 1,939 CE.

Scat: Louis Armstrong, *"Heebie Jeebies,"* c. 1,926 CE. The Mills Brothers, *"Tiger Rag,"* c. 1,931 CE. Cab Calloway, *"Hi-De-Ho,"* c. 1,934 CE. Ella Fitzgerald, *"A-Tisket, A-Tasket,"* c. 1,938 CE.

Bebop: Coleman Hawkins, *"Rainbow Mist,"* c. 1,944 CE. Dizzy Gillespie, *"Groovin' High,"* c. 1,945 CE. CE. Charlie "Yardbird" Parker, *"Now's The Time,"* c. 1,945 CE. Miles Davis, *"First Miles,"* c. 1,945 CE. Thelonious Monk, *"Round Midnight,"* c. 1,947 CE. John Coltrane, *"Giant Steps,"* c. 1,959 CE.

Latin Jazz: For authenticity, Dizzy Gillespie's band featured Chano Pozo, c. 1,947 CE. Carnegie Hall performance. Collaborations with Chano Pozo and Mario Bauzá further developed Latin Jazz, a genre created in the United States of America.

"Jazz is known all over the world as an American musical art form and that's it. No America, no jazz. I've seen people try to connect it to other countries, for instance to Africa, but it doesn't have a damn thing to do with Africa." -Art Blakey

Preservationists of Ragtime, Jazz, Big Band, Swing, Scat, Bebop, and Latin Jazz: Scott Joplin, George Washington, Johnson, Cab Calloway, Count Basie, Nat King Cole, Louis Armstrong, Fletcher Henderson, Duke Ellington, Fats Waller, Ella Fitzgerald, Ethel Waters, Lena Horne, Billie Holiday, Pearl Bailey, Bessie Smith, Lionel Hampton, The Mills Brothers, The Nicholas Brothers, John Coltrane, Thelonious Monk, Dinah Washington, Miles Davis, Dizzy Gillespie, Billy Eckstine, Sarah Vaughn, Charlie Parker, Coleman Hawkins, Nina Simone, Etta James, Quincy Jones, Roy Ayers, Herbie Hancock, The Crusaders, Ramsey Lewis, Nancy Wilson, Johnny Mathis, George Benson, Grover Washington, Herman Poole Blount, "*Sun Ra*" —first commercial record made with Mini moog synthesizer "*Space Probe*"

Blues: W. C. Handy, "*Memphis Blues*," c. 1,912 CE. "*St. Louis Blues*," c. 1,914 CE. Mamie Smith and her Jazz Hounds, "*Crazy Blues*," c. 1,920 CE. Grammy Hall of Fame, c. 1,994 CE. Muddy Waters "*The Father of Chicago Blues*," "*Country Blues*," c. 1,941 CE, and "I Be's Troubled" c. 1,941 CE.

Boogie Woogie: Pinetop Smith, "*Pinetop's Boogie Woogie*," c. 1,929 CE.

Jump Blues: Louis Jordan, "*Is You Is Or Is You Ain't My Baby?*," c. 1,944 CE.

Preservationists of Blues, Boogie Woogie, and Jump Blues: Otis Rush, Buddy Guy, and Magic Sam played guitar-based Blues which inspired rock and roll. B.B. King, Etta James, Ray Charles, Muddy Waters, Bo Diddley, Otis Redding, Mamie Smith, Billie Holiday, Nina Simone, Bessie Smith, Ethel Waters, Robert Johnson, Al Green, Louis Armstrong, Buddy Guy, Albert King, Lightnin' Hopkins, T-Bone Walker, Willie Dixon, Mississippi John Hurt, Sonny Boy Williamson II, Son House, Bobby Rush, Little Walker, Albert "*The Iceman*" Collins, Blind Willie Johnson, Big Mama Thornton, Blind Lemon Jefferson, Huddie William "*Lead Belly*" Lebetter, Charlie Patton, Jimmy Reed, Big Bill Broonzy, R. L. Burnside, Mississippi Fred McDowell, Bobby "Blue" Bland, Sonny Boy Williamson I, Skip James, Hubert Sumlin, Clarence "*Gatemouth*" Brown, James Cotton, Memphis Slim, Magic Slim, Otis Rush, Magic Sam, Big Joe Turner, Pinetop Perkins, Earl Hooker, Otis Spann, Big Joe Williams, Lonnie Johnson, Johnny Copeland, Ma Rainey, Reverend Gary Davis, Robert Lockwood Jr., "*Queen of the Blues*," Memphis Minnie, Dinah Washington, Furry Lewis, Tommy Johnson, Big Walter Horton, Son Seals, Big Maybelle, Robert Nighthawk, Louis Jordan, Little Milton, Leroy Carr, Pete Johnson, Mississippi Sheiks, Matt "*Guitar*" Murphy...

Country: Before the Country genre, enslaved folk musicians developed a distinct down-stroke—clawhammer or frailing technique on stringed instruments exclusively handmade by Black Americans, c. 1,600-1,800 CE. Phil Jamison's book *Hoedowns, Reels,*

and Frolics: Roots and Branches of Southern Appalachian Dance discovered archival evidence of Black American dance callers, hoedowns, square dances, fiddlers, and banjo players in the Southern Appalachia, c. 1,690-1,800 CE. European descendant Americans mocked Black Americans in minstrel shows and later adopted the traditions. Artists painted the enslaved as musicians, *"The Old Plantation,"* John Rose, c. 1,785 CE.

Deford Bailey, *"Harmonica Wizard"* and Grand Ole Opry original performer, c. 1,925 CE. Deford Bailey And The Golden Echo Quartet, c. 1,927 CE. *"Pan American Express,"* c. 1,927 CE. *"Hesitation,"* c. 1,927 CE. Country Music Hall of Fame, c. 2,005 CE.

As a child, *"Jimmie,"* James Charles Rodgers, *"The Father Of Country Music"* learned the banjo and guitar from Black American railroad workers. Hank Williams referenced Rufus *"Tee Tot"* Payne saying, *"All the musical training I ever had was from him."* Black Americans originated Country music.

Preservationists of Country: Delford Bailey, Lesley Riddle, Charley Pride...

Bluegrass: Arnold Schultz, a Black American developed the *"Travis picking"/"thumb-style."* Bill Monroe credited Schultz as a formative influence. Schultz taught Kenny Jones, Merle Travis, and Ike Everly who carried on the picking style. John Lusk, Murph Gribble, Albert York *"Rolling River,"* c. 1,946 CE.

Rock and Roll: Black Americans used the words *"Rock and Roll"*—meaning to have sex colloquially and in music lyrics. Trixie Smith, *"My Man Rocks Me With One Steady Roll,"* c. 1,922 CE.

Robert Johnson, *"Cross Roads Blues"* *"Terraplane Blues,"* c. 1,936 CE. c. 1,936 CE.

Sister Rosetta Tharpe, *"Rock Me,"* c. 1,938 CE.

Arthur Crudup, *"That's All Right Mama,"* c. 1,946 CE.

Wynonie Harris, *"Good Rockin Tonight,"* c. 1,948 CE.

Jackie Brenston, *"Rocket 88,"* c. 1,951 CE.

Bo Diddley, *"Bo Diddley,"* c. 1,955 CE.

Chuck Berry, *"Maybellene,"* c. 1,955 CE.

Little Richard, *"Tutti Frutti,"* c. 1,955 CE.

Punk Rock: Death Band—Bobby, David, and Dannis Hackney, *"Spiritual • Mental • Physical,"* c. 1,974-1,976 CE.

Grunge Rock: Tina Marie Bell and Bam Bam, *"Villains (Also Wear White),"* c. 1,984 CE.

"We recorded 'Rocket 88' and you know that's why they say 'Rocket 88' was the first rock 'n' roll song, but the truth of the matter is, I don't think that 'Rocket 88' is rock 'n' roll. I think that 'Rocket 88' is R&B, but I think 'Rocket 88' is the cause of rock and roll existing." -Ike Turner

Roy Hamilton, the man behind Elvis Presley's style and voice, signed with Okeh Records, a subsidiary of Columbia Records, c. 1,953 CE.

Preservationists of Rock and Roll: Robert Johnson, Sister Rosetta Tharpe, Wynonie Harris, Jackie Brenston, Chuck Berry, Little Richard, Chubby Checker, Fats Domino, Bo Diddley, Big Mama Thornton, Hank Ballard and the Midnighters, Ike and Tina Turner, Frankie Lymon, Jimi Hendrix, Sly and the Family Stone, Prince...

Military Cadence: Willie Duckworth—WWII soldier *"Duckworth Chant/Sound Off!,"* c. 1,944 CE.

Doo-Wop Boy Bands: The Ink Spots, *"My Prayer,"* c. 1,939 CE. The Turbans, *"When You Dance,"* c. 1,955 CE. The Jackson Five, *"I Want You Back,"* c. 1,969 CE.

Rhythm and Blues/R&B: Ray Charles, *"Confession Blues,"* c. 1,948 CE. The Orioles, *"It's Too Soon To Know,"* c. 1,948 CE. Little Richard, *"Tutti Frutti,"* c. 1,955 CE. Sam Cooke, *"You Send Me,"* c. 1,957 CE. James Brown, *"Please Please Please,"* c. 1,958 CE. Aretha Franklin, *"Aretha,"* c. 1,960 CE.

Soul: Sam Cooke, *"You Send Me,"* c. 1,957 CE. James "Godfather Of Soul" Brown, *"Try Me,"* c. 1,958 CE. Ray Charles, *"What'd I Say,"* c. 1,959 CE.

Preservationists of Rhythm and Blues and Soul: Aretha Franklin, James Brown, Ray Charles and the Raelettes, Sam Cooke, Jackie Wilson, Otis Redding, B.B. King, Jerry Butler, The Impressions, Little Anthony and the Imperials, Millie Jackson, Betty Wright, Rosco Gordon, Al Green, Stevie Wonder, Earth Wind and Fire, Marvin Gaye, Isley Brothers, Donny Hathaway, Roberta Flack, The Whispers, Curtis Mayfield, The Staple Singers, The Friends Of Distinction, Bobby Womack, Michael Jackson, Prince, Switch, Sylvers, Shalimar, Kool in the Gang, Luther Vandross, Whitney Houston, Denise Williams, Minnie Riperton, Patrice Rushen, Dionne Warwick, Billy Preston, The 5th Dimension, James Ingram, Bill Withers, Luther Ingram...

Motown Sound: Motown artists: Marv Johnson—“*Come To Me*,” c. 1,959 CE, the first Tamla/Motown record, The Jackson Five, Diana Ross, The Supremes, Marvin Gaye, Mary Wells, The Marvelettes, The Dramatics, Smokey Robinson, The Miracles, The Ch-Lites, Eddie Kendricks, The Temptations, Martha and the Vandellas, The Four Tops, The Spinners, Gladys Knight and The Pips, The Commodores, The Funk Brothers...

Funk: James Brown, “*Out Of Sight*,” c. 1,964 CE. “*Papa’s Got A Brand New Bag*,” c. 1,965 CE. “*Cold Sweat*,” c. 1,967 CE. Funkadelic, George Clinton, “*One Nation Under A Groove*,” c. 1,978 CE.

Preservationists of Funk: James Brown, Parliament and Funkadelic, Zapp and Roger, Rick James, The Gap Band, The Bar-Kays, L.T.D., The Ohio Players, Lakeside, Commodores and Lionel Richie, Cameo, Stevie Wonder, Earth Wind and Fire, The Ohio Players, The Brothers Johnson, Prince...

Disco: In Harlem, spacious city loft residents hosted “*Rent Parties*” and laid the foundation for the disco scene, c. 1,920 CE. Barry White, The Love Unlimited Orchestra, “*Love’s Theme*” written, c. 1,965 CE and recorded, c. 1,973 CE.

Preservationists of Disco: Barry White, Isaac Hayes, Donna Summer, Evelyn “*Champagne*” King, Thelma Houston, Gloria Gaynor, Rose Royce, Chic, The Pointer Sisters, A Taste Of Honey...

Philadelphia Sound: Gamble and Huff, “*The Sound of Philadelphia-TSOF*,” c. 1,974 CE.

Preservationists of the Philadelphia Sound: Gamble and Huff, The Sound of Philadelphia-TSOF, c. 1,974 CE, McFadden & Whitehead, The Three Degrees, Billy Paul, The Intruders, Teddy Pendergrass, Harold Melvin & The Blue Notes, The Delphonics, MFSB, The Stylistics, The Dells, The Trammps, Patti LaBelle, Sister Sledge, Blue Magic, The O’Jays, Frankie Beverly and Maze...

House and Electric: Jesse Saunders, “*On & On*,” c. 1,984 CE.

Evolution of Rap: Beale Street Sheiks recorded works, c. 1,927-1,929 CE. Frankie “*Halfpint*” Jaxon, recorded works, c. 1,926-1,940 CE. Fisk Jubilee Singers, “*Preacher’s Delight*,” c. 1,937 CE. The Mills Brothers, “*Caravan*,” c. 1,938 CE. Louis Thomas Jordan, “*You Gotta Have A Beat*,” c. 1,940 CE.

Muhammad Ali, “*I Am The Greatest*,” c. 1,963 CE. Pigmeat Markham, “*Here Comes The Judge*,” c. 1,968 CE.

"K.C. *The Prince of Soul*," rhythmically rhymed over Disco records, c. 1,970 CE. "*Disco King Mario*" hosted large parties and park jams, c. 1,970 CE.

In New York's Charles Gallery, a Bunch of Grapes, the Stardust Ballroom, and the Apollo Theater, Anthony Holloway aka "*DJ Hollywood*" created "*Disco Rap*" with continuous rhymes over MC announcements.

The words "*Hip-Hop*" and "*Throw your hands in the air*" rang out over Disco percussion sections, c. 1,971 CE. "*DJ Hollywood*," Robert Keith Wiggins—"Keef Keith Cowboy" and Kevin Smith—"Lovebug Starski"...rhymed the words "*Hip-Hop*" over R&B, Funk, and Soul genres, which marked the origins of modern "*Rap*" and "*Hip-Hop*."

Fatback Band, Bill Curtis, "*King Tim III—Personality Jock*," c. 3-25- 1,979 CE. The genre evolved with Tupac Shakur.

Evolution of Disc Jockeys: Jack L. Cooper, a National Radio Hall of Fame disc jockey, c. 1,930 CE. Mary Elizabeth Goode "*Mary Dee*," radio disc jockey—used two turntables, c. 1,940-1,960 CE.

Jonathon Cameron Flowers, "*Grandmaster Flowers*" opened for James Brown at Yankee Stadium and used three turntables, c. 1,969 CE. Pete Jones, "*Pete DJ Jones*," radio disc jockey, c. 1,970-1,980 CE. Anthony Holloway aka "*DJ Hollywood*," c. 1,971 CE.

Fatback Band/Bill Curtis recorded "*King Tim III—Personality Jock*," c. 3-25-1,979 CE. Darren "*The Human Beat Box*" Robinson—Big Buff—the Ox That Rocks won a Radio City Music Hall talent contest, c. 1,983 CE.

Breakdance Evolution: One of Thomas Edison's early motion pictures, "*The Pickaninny Dance from The Passing Show*," c. 1,894 CE.

Mills Brothers, "*Caravan*," c. 1,938 CE. Will Maston Trio, "*Dancing Boogie*," c. 1,938 CE. Bill Bailey, "*The Cabin In The Sky*," "*Backslide or Moonwalk*," c. 1,943 CE.

James Brown, *splits, boogaloo, shuffle*, c. 1,960-2,000 CE. Don "*Campbellock*" Campbell, Soul Train, c. 1,971-1,973 CE. Sam Solomon, "*Boogaloo Sam*" and Timothy Solomon, "*Popin' Pete*" Soul Train, c. 1,970-1,980 CE.

Hip-Hop: The Cincinnati Enquirer mentioned the word "*Hep*," a version of "*Hip*," which meant "*to be aware*" or "*to be in the know*," c. 5-9-1,903 CE. The word "*Hop*" referred to informal dances, recorded, c. 1,700 CE. Military article, "*Hip, Hop, Thuh-ree, Fo*," c. Great Lakes Bulletin, c. 12-4-1,970 CE.

Urban Graffiti: Darryl McCray, *"Cornbread,"* c. 1,965 CE. Graffiti, derived from the Italian word *graffio*—"scratch"—dates back thousands of years in ancient Greece, Pompeii, and Anatolia.

Grills: A symbol of wealth, gold and bejeweled teeth originate in Egypt.

Custom Cars: Low Riders highlight customized paint finishes, murals, windows, hydraulics, body modifications, interiors, engines, drivetrains, suspensions, wheels, rims, and horns.

Black American WWII veterans, skilled in aircraft mechanics, experimented with hydraulics and modified automobiles from the 1940s to the 1980s. A notable figure, Sonny Sims, designed a powerful multi-pump setup, which enabled cars to lift off the ground or *"hop"* in 1967.

Founded by Charles *"Big Red"* Bell, in 1952, Hot-Rodders established a clubhouse for the *Low Riders*, a name coined by Berta Bell, located at 1423 E. 53rd Street.

The first mention of Low Riders appeared in the article *"Stolen Car Parts Seized, Hot-Rod Gang Arrested."* -*California Eagle*, Los Angeles, May 30, 1957.

In 1963, Victor Murphy exhibited adjustable suspension, *"hopping,"* craftsmanship installed by Bill Hines of Lynwood, California. Al *"Old Man"* Sullivan produced hydraulic masterpieces from a shop located near Crenshaw Boulevard and 8th Street, Los Angeles, California.

Athen Nelson engineered *"three-wheel motion,"* where one rear wheel lifts while the opposite front and rear wheels remain grounded.

Low Rider Hall of Fame: Ted Wells, Tina L. Blankenship-Early, Gary May...

The band WAR recorded the culture into history with *"Lowrider"* in 1975.

Dance Genres: Performers tapped across the silver screen—the Nicolas Brothers, Bill *"Bojangles"* Robinson, and John W. Bubbles, Fred Astaire's mentor. Partiers buck danced, boogie-woogied, cakewalked, jitterbugged, jooked, and jived.

As Dance crazes swept the world, flappers Charlestoned and acrobatics shone through Swing Dancers and Lindy hoppers. Hips rocked and rolled to the Twist. Stars from the cosmos fell and spun glittery balls over Discotheques. In the streets and on the Soul Train line, Hip-Hop produced urban dances—Breakers, B-Boys, Boogalooers, Pop-

Lockers, Turfers, Krumpers, and Crip Walkers. Stylized moves developed—Robot, Worm, Jerk, Centipede, Cabbage Patch, Dougie, Humpty, Moonwalk, Hammertime, and HBCU Marching.

Reggae: After World War II, a labor shortage in the United States of America attracted workers from the Caribbean. The workers discovered Black American dance/block parties, c. 1,945 CE. The workers returned home with Black American albums, DJ equipment, and techniques, c. 1,945-1,950 CE. *“Tom the Great Sebastian,”* a Chinese-Jamaican businessman—Tom Wong, founded the first commercially successful sound system, c. 1,950 CE. Caribbeans hosted *“Blues Parties”* and played Black American music on sound systems, c. 1,950 CE.

Rosco Gordon’s *“No More Doggin”* accented on the off beats. *“Rosco Rhythm,”* c. 1,952 CE, formed the foundation of ska and rocksteady, c. 1,960 CE. Robert *“Bobby”* Spencer of the Cadillacs, published *“My Boy Lollipop,”* c. 1,956. Johnny Nash, a Black American signed with a Kingston, Jamaica record company. The singer topped the charts with the first in a string of international reggae songs, *“Hold Me Tight,”* c. 1,968 CE. Johnny Nash introduced *“Stir It Up,”* written by Bob Marley and signed the Wailers to JAD Records.

Chinese Jamaicans worked in obscurity as producers, technicians, and distributors of reggae music, c. 1,960-1,970 CE. The *“Blues Party”* tradition morphed into dancehall music, popular in the Caribbean and the United Kingdom, c. 1,970-1,980 CE.

Highlife: Sailors and British colonists in Africa, introduced brass instruments and Black American jazz. The name *“Highlife”* originated from aristocratic audiences and exclusive clubs. Highlife fused Akan and Kpanlogo music traditions with Jazz and later Rock, Hip-Hop, and Afrobeat. E.T. Mensah, the *“King of Highlife,”* played with Louis Armstrong.

“I started out playing Highlife and was the first to modernize it with Rock, Jazz, and R&B. It was Afrobeat, but my record company called it Afro-Soul.” -Orlando Owoh Julius.

“Jazz has formed the foundation for Ghana’s cultural and music scene. South African Amapiano, R&B...and it’s a genre that continues to grow with each new generation.” -Ken Agyapong Jr., an Afrochella founder.

Afrobeat: Born in Nigeria, under British colonial rule, Fela Kuti traveled to New York for musical inspiration and discovered “Blackness.” The Nigerian musician fused the rhythms of James Brown, the improvisation of Miles Davis, and the soul of Motown with Highlife and Yoruba percussion.

"It was incredible how my head was turned. Everything fell into place, man," Fela says. "For the first time, I saw the essence of blackism [black nationalism]. It's crazy; in the States, people think the black-power movement drew inspiration from Africa. All these Americans come over here looking for awareness. They don't realize they're the ones who've got it over there. Why we were even ashamed to go around in national dress until we saw pictures of blacks wearing dashikis on 125th St."

Fela Kuti, James Brown and the invention of Afrobeat, by Alexander Stewart, p. 104.

Hip hop, funk, jazz, rock, and pop developed into Africanized hip hop, Afrobeats, Mbalax, Makossa, Bongo Flava, Soukous, Singeli, Grime, UK Garage, Afroswing, jungle music, Dub, Kwaito, Amapiano, Asianized pop, Latinized hip hop, and Europeanized rock, pop, hip hop, and jazz.

Ethnocide and Global Censures

"Our music (jazz) is strictly white man's music...My contention is that the Negroes learned to play this rhythm and music from the whites...The Negro did not play any kind of music equal to white men at any time." -Band Leader, Nick LaRocca.

The United States of America, the United Kingdom, NAZI Germany, Italy, Japan, China, and Russia enacted laws and global campaigns to censor Black American music with the terms, "race records," "n—er music," "music of the lower races," "jungle music," and "enemy music."

"Monkey talk, jungle squeals, grunts and squeaks, and gasps suggestive of calf love are camouflaged by a few feverish notes and admitted in homes where the thing itself, unaided by scanned music," would be stamped out in horror. The fluttering music sheets disclose expressions taken directly from the cesspools of modern capitals, to be made the daily slang, the thoughtlessly hummed remarks of school boys and girls." -Henry Ford.

Origins

The notion that the enslaved preserved and passed on intact culture in a cruel, chaotic environment reeks of delusion. Afrocentrists and Eurocentrists link African "call and response," European instruments, and polyphonic compositions to Black American music genres. Traditional genres on six continents feature "call and response."

Greco-Romans learned musicology and organology from ancient Egyptians.

"Pythagoras learned the harmonious proportions of music, which the Egyptians taught as a means of understanding the cosmos." -Iamblichus, On the Pythagorean Life.

"Pythagoras traveled to Egypt and was initiated into the sacred mysteries, where he acquired knowledge that surpassed all human learning." -Iamblichus, On the Pythagorean Life.

"I have learned that the Egyptians are the most ancient of all philosophers, and that Pythagoras, who was educated by them, obtained a knowledge of the divine principles and the mysteries of the universe." -Iamblichus, On the Mysteries.

"Pythagoras discovered the relationships between musical intervals through the study of the Egyptian music, where the harmony of the spheres was revealed." -Plutarch, On Music.

"When Pythagoras of Samos visited Egypt and became their pupil, he was the first to bring to the Greeks all philosophy..." -Isocrates, Busiris.

"As to his knowledge, it is said that he learned the mathematical sciences from the Egyptians, Chaldeans, and Phoenicians; for of old the Egyptians excelled in geometry, the Phoenicians in numbers and proportions, and the Chaldeans in astronomical theorems, divine rites, and worship of the gods." -Porphyry, Life of Pythagoras.

"Pythagoras, who was initiated into the sacred rites of the Egyptians, received his knowledge from the priests and thus established the principles of his philosophy." -Proclus, commentary on Plato's Timaeus.

Egyptians collected, standardized, and categorized percussion, wind, and string instruments, c. 5,000 BCE.

Conclusion

A legacy of complex melodies, layered instruments, and harmonic vocal styles developed in relative isolation. The foundations—pitch, scales, chords, and rhythm, structure an original creative interpretation and tradition.

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